

Consent & Terms of Use for STEP Interventions

Acknowledgment and Consent

Welcome to the STEP Intervention. This document provides an overview of what to expect, including the purpose, structure, and potential benefits and risks of participation.

Please read it carefully and ask any questions before signing.

STEP Intervention Provider

Protocol Information

Please refer to the Information Letter for details related to the protocol. The letter outlines details about the STEP intervention, the purpose of the intervention, information on who can participate, well-being priorities, confidentiality, data collection, research participation, and details about the specific intervention you will be using.

Your Rights

You have the right to make decisions about your care. This includes the right to:

- ask questions about the process, techniques, and goals.
- give or withhold consent for any part of this intervention.
- participate actively in setting goals and making decisions about the direction of this intervention.
- discontinue the use of this intervention at any time without feeling pressured or obligated.

You are encouraged to ask your STEP Intervention Provider any questions at any time. Before proceeding, it is important that you feel comfortable and confident in your understanding of the intervention. Your consent is a way to ensure you are well-informed and actively engaged in this experience.

Participation Criteria

This protocol is not suitable if you:

- have suicidal thoughts;
- have a diagnosis of a psychotic or dissociative disorder; or
- experience hallucinations, delusions, or dissociation.

If you are experiencing any of the above or are unsure if you are, please contact your STEP Intervention Provider for support and to discuss the next steps in your care.

Safety and Confidentiality

During your participation in the STEP Intervention, you may experience emotional reactions, such as distressing memories or heightened emotions. This is a natural part of the processing experience.

It is typical to feel disturbance during the processing of an overwhelming event or series of events. If, however, you are feeling excessively overwhelmed and don't want to continue, please stop using the protocol and connect with your STEP Intervention Provider to discuss alternative interventions or treatments. You will have access to strategies and techniques for self-regulation to assist you while contacting your STEP Intervention Provider. They will help assess your needs and determine the next steps in your care.

We are committed to protecting your privacy and maintaining confidentiality of the information you share. However, there are some legal and ethical limits to confidentiality, which include the following situations where your STEP Intervention Provider may be required to disclose information:

- Risk of Harm to Self or Others – If you express a serious intent to harm yourself or another person, your STEP Intervention Provider will need to take necessary steps to ensure safety, which may include notifying emergency services or appropriate individuals.
- Abuse or Neglect – If your STEP Intervention Provider has reason to believe that a child, elderly person, or vulnerable adult is being abused, neglected, or exploited, they are legally required to report this to the appropriate authorities.

- Legal Requirements – If your STEP Intervention Provider receives a court order or subpoena, they may be required to disclose certain information as mandated by law.
- Professional Consultation – In some cases, your STEP Intervention Provider may consult with other mental health professionals to provide you with the best possible care. However, these discussions will be kept confidential, and identifying details will not be shared unless necessary.
- Compliance with

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If you have any questions or concerns about confidentiality and its limits, please feel free to discuss them with your STEP Intervention Provider. We strive to create a safe and supportive space for you.

Data Collection & Research

Your responses will be sent to your STEP Intervention Provider for monitoring. Data collected will be stored securely in an encrypted format through Formstack, a platform that provides strong security measures to protect your information. The protocol developers, Prepped 4 Learning Inc., will not have access to identifiable information. Anonymous data may be used for research, teaching purposes, or to improve the protocol. Participation in research is voluntary, and you can withdraw at any time without affecting your therapy. To opt out of the research, inform your STEP Intervention Provider, who will contact the Prepped 4 Learning Inc. team and instruct them to delete your data.

Personal Use Only

By participating in STEP, you agree to:

- not to share, distribute, or copy materials from the protocol.
- maintain confidentiality of passwords used to access the protocol.
- use the protocol for self-use and not for financial gain or professional purposes.

All materials are protected by copyright laws, and unauthorized distribution is prohibited.

Information About STEP Services

STEP is a self-help intervention and does not establish a professional-client relationship with the protocol developers, Prepped 4 Learning Inc. or its affiliates. The responsibility for my care rests with the service provider (the STEP Intervention Provider) and not the protocol developers, Prepped 4 Learning Inc. Participants are encouraged to seek professional care if needed. Please contact your STEP Intervention Provider to assess your needs and determine options for your care as needed.

Withdrawal and Termination

Your STEP Intervention Provider and/or Prepped 4 Learning Inc. reserves the right to terminate access if the terms of use are violated.

Group Intervention Confidentiality (for those participating in STEP Together)

In STEP Together, maintaining confidentiality is crucial. Participants agree to:

- maintain confidentiality by not recording or taking notes that identify group members.
- respect the privacy and confidentiality of others by not sharing information about fellow participants outside of the group.
- ensure a private setting when participating virtually.

Agreement

I confirm that I:

- ☐ do not meet any exclusion criteria.
- ☐ have read, understand, and agree to the STEP Intervention Information Letter.
- ☐ have read, understand, and agree to the Terms of Use.
- ☐ agree to use the protocol solely for its intended purpose.
- ☐ release the protocol developer, Prepped 4 Learning Inc., from liability related to participation.
- ☐ understand the responsibility for my care rests with my STEP Intervention Provider and that the use of this protocol does not constitute a professional client-therapist relationship with the protocol developer, Prepped 4 Learning Inc.
- ☐ have been informed about data handling and research participation.
- ☐ have been informed about confidentiality and its limits.
- ☐ have voluntarily agreed to participate and understand that I can withdraw without penalty at any time.
- ☐ have read and understand the risks and benefits of the STEP intervention.
- ☐ understand the limitations of the use of technology and agree to use the processes in place if any issues are encountered.
- ☐ understand and agree to the expectations of participants.
- ☐ understand that the STEP intervention is protected by copyright and intellectual property laws and agree not to duplicate, reproduce, or distribute it in any form.
- ☐ understand that this intervention is for self-care and/or maintenance and **is not intended as a substitute for professional medical or psychological advice, diagnosis or treatment.**

Participant Name:

Signature:

Date: